



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

devatābhyas tu tadd hutvā vanyaṃ medhyataraṃ haviḥ | 6.12a

śeṣam ātmani yuñjīta lavaṇaṃ ca svayaṃ kṛtam || 12 || 6.12c

sthalaja.audakaśākāni puṣpa.mūla.phalāni ca | 6.13a

medhyavṛkṣa.udbhavāny adyāt snehāṃś ca phala.sambhavān || 13 || 6.13c

— Manusmṛti, 6.1.2.2. Food (Chapter 2), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This passage from the Manusmṛti guides you towards a life lived in harmony with nature and attuned to the divine within. It speaks of a hermits's existence, but the underlying principles can illuminate your path regardless of your lifestyle. The verses emphasize purity and the offering of gratitude before consumption. "Having offered that wild, particularly pure oblation to the gods," highlights the importance of acknowledging the source of your sustenance. This isn't simply about performing a ritual; it's about cultivating a mindset of thankfulness for the gifts of the earth and the divine forces that sustain all life.

The instruction to "use the remainder for himself, and salt prepared by himself" encourages self-reliance and mindful consumption. Preparing your own food, even something as simple as salt, connects you more deeply to the process of nourishment. You become aware of the effort and intention that goes into creating a meal. This act of self-sufficiency promotes a sense of responsibility and appreciation for what you consume.

Furthermore, the text details what one should eat: "terrestrial and aquatic vegetables, flowers, roots and fruits, produced by pure trees, and oily substances derived from fruits." This list emphasizes a diet based on natural, unprocessed foods. It encourages you to consume what is readily available in your environment, connecting you to the rhythms of nature. Choosing wholesome, plant-based foods nourishes not only your body but also your mind and spirit. In modern life, this translates to prioritizing fresh, locally sourced produce and minimizing processed foods laden with artificial ingredients.

Ultimately, this passage calls you to live a life of mindful consumption, gratitude, and connection to nature. By acknowledging the source of your food, preparing it with intention, and choosing wholesome ingredients, you cultivate a deeper sense of well-being and spiritual connection. This ancient wisdom invites you to transform your relationship with food from a mere act of sustenance to a sacred practice of honoring the divine within and without.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you incorporate more mindful consumption practices into your daily life to cultivate a deeper sense of gratitude and connection to the natural world?